
Parvathy Baajee

Yoga Teacher

 +91 8309736620 | bpat07@gmail.com
 | IG: ashtangayoga_ajourneywithin

My Profile

An ardent student of Yoga philosophy and practice, I have been a keen observer of how breath, movement and meditation plays into the key aspects of daily life. I have been a student of Ashtanga, Vinyasa based movement, Iyengar practices and Hatha yoga since I first started my practice in 2007.

In the practice, my primary area of study is how breath and movement is correlated and how it can heal our body if we move intuitively. Movements to build strength and flexibility, to bring ease and flow is a part of my practice and my teaching style mirrors the philosophy of yoga. Chanting, mudras, kriya yog and pranayam has healing benefits so it finds its place when I am teaching, and qi gong and acupuncture always interested me so I took up a course on Acupuncture and since I have also been studying Ayurveda under the guidance of Dr. Arun Sharma I am currently integrating it into the practice for my own benefit and the benefit of the students.

The ashtanga system is built on an intelligent sequencing of postures to cleanse the body of toxins and to build strength and flexibility. It is from my regular practice of Ashtanga yoga that I developed a style called functional movement which includes a series of asanas to focus on strength, flexibility, Qi flow movements and at the same time I keep it flexible based on students' needs which can vary depending on their energy levels.

I believe my purpose is to serve and inspire others to find joy in everyday living, be healthy and set meaningful goals that they can achieve. Yoga is a journey when undertaken leads to positive wellbeing as well as allowing individuals to get connected to their inner struggles, fears and debilitations and overcome them through developing peace in the mind and body. I like to stay grounded in these facts through my own sadhana (practice), and self- inquiry thereby allowing me to connect with everyone I meet and provide guidance when called for during the practice of asanas.

I started my yogic path in 2007 studying Iyengar Yoga daily for a period of 2 and a half years. When I moved to U.S. I continued to practice Vinyasa before undertaking the journey on the Ashtanga path.

As the name suggests it talks about 8 limbs of yoga and when I practice my main focus is on the first 4 limbs of yoga mainly Yamas (right living), Niyamas (positive observances), Asanas (posture) and Pranayama (breathing technique). I also have a daily meditation practice once in the morning and once in the evening.

I have worked with people having different ailments (scoliosis, open heart surgery recovery, Arthritis), kids, super seniors (70+ years of age) by giving dietary suggestions and adapting different movements for recovery.

Experience

Personal and Group Trainer, Jakarta

July 2015 - PRESENT

- My teachings are mainly focused towards individuals on a one on one basis and groups sharing intelligent movement based on the sequence of the Ashtanga yoga system and fundamental movement.
- The ages I have taught has varied from early 20s' - 70s', with different body types, and temperaments. As Sri Tirumalai Krishnamacharya said, "Yoga has to be taught as it applies to the individual in front of you". I believe this is so true in my experience of teaching.
- Focus on teaching asanas in a sequence with emphasis on breathing, alignment, and body awareness
- Focus on breath (ujjayi pranayama), asanas (posture) and drishti (gaze/focus on one point).
- Focus on adjustments which is an integral part of yoga practice
- Teaching asanas with special attention to fundamental body movement and alignment.
 - Discuss philosophy of yoga from time to time.
- I arrange sequences based on the needs of the individual at the present moment.
- I have worked with students with carpal tunnel syndrome, joint pain, eczema, sjogren's syndrome by giving dietary suggestions and adapting different movements for recovery.
- Also teach students with mild to severe scoliosis
- Sharing yoga with 79 year old who is a Tai chi practitioner has been one if the highlights of my experience

-
- One of my students who is in cancer remission cannot do most of the exercises or movement because her breathing capacity is shallow so we focus on normal breaths to meditation with healing music and slow movement.
 - Meditation
 - Chanting for vocal practice and sound healing
 - Currently, I have been teaching 95 years young, cheerful and wonderful personality, for the past 2 years. Working on mental health, positivity, sound and breathing exercises and various physio therapy and therapeutic movements to maintain mobility. Working on gaining confidence in walking again after a fall that slowed down the movements and is recuperating very well.

Yoga Trainer - Faith Yoga Studio, Jakarta Indonesia

November 2017 – February 2020

- Taught Mysore Ashtanga, Led Ashtanga, Vinyasa class and Fundamental movement for developing strength and flexibility since November of 2017 at Faith Studio in Jakarta.
- Focused on adjustments and fundamental body movements thereby bringing awareness to different body parts.
- Taught fundamental movement for awareness and conscious movement of body for building strength and improving flexibility.
- I incorporated mat pilates for core strengthening.
- Focused on strength training during sessions.
- Focus on breathing patterns. Before every session checked on everyone's well-being, and made modifications if necessary, as needed.
- Pranayama (breathing technique) and meditation
- Chanting prayers in Sanskrit with a group every Tuesday and Thursday and kept the studio clean and tidy before and after sessions.

Yoga Trainer – Mood Studio, Jakarta Indonesia

September 2019 – April 2020

Taught Ashtanga Mysore yoga once a week at Mood studio since September 2019. On the onset of Covid I taught classes online on meditation and flow for the studio.

Divine Tree -The Yoga Shala, Hyderabad

April 2021 – March 2022

I incorporated mat pilates for core strengthening and also worked on moving Qi through the body. So that involves different Qi Gong movements to stay connected with the ground and on allowing flow of Qi.

Focus was on integrating Mudra, Pranyama, Iyengar based movement, Vinyasa and Ashtanga system on an intuitive level.

At present doing 1:1 and group & online sessions.

Professional Courses and Certifications

SAMYAK YOGA, Mysore - India - *Ashtanga Yoga Trainer*

Diploma in Natural Acupuncture from International School of Natural Acupuncture, under the guidance of Dr. Nemi of Acuveda

Certificate course in yoga from Kaivalyadhama, Mumbai

200 Hr International Yoga Teacher Training Course with specialization in Ashtanga Yoga completed in May 2015 from SAMYAK YOGA, Mysore

200 hr Certificate course in yoga from Kaivalyadhama, Mumbai in 2024

YOGAWORKS, Walnut Creek, CA - USA - *Pilates Mat Trainer*

JUNE 2014 - JUNE 2014

Pilates Mat Teacher Training, Completed in 2014 at Yogaworks in California, USA

KPJAYI SHALA, Mysore - India - *Ashtanga Yoga Studies*

JAN 2016, FEB 2016, JUNE 2017, December 2018, July 2019 (Continuing Education)
Continuing Ashtanga studies since 2016 at the KPJayi shala in Mysore, India under the guidance of R. Saraswathi Jois

Also studied Ashtanga in Jakarta under the guidance of Hortario Perez in 2016 and 2018

Hortario Perez, Authorized Level 2, Jakarta - Indonesia - *Ashtanga Yoga Studies*

AUGUST 2015 - SEPTEMBER 2015 / OCTOBER 2017

Continuing education on various subjects to understand how the external world affects the internal world and vice versa.

Studying Bhagavad Gita under the guidance of Mrs. Preeti in Hyderabad since 2022.

Other Yoga Engagements

- Volunteered for the event Yoga Stops Trafficking organized by Oadanadi, an NGO in Mysore, India in 2016
- Taught yoga to kids of ages 6-8 at the ACG International School, Jakarta, Indonesia in November 2016 and June 2017
- Taught yoga for a group of boys in the age group of 13-17 in one of the shelter homes run for refugees by UNHCR in Jakarta, Indonesia

Education

- PGDMM (Post Graduate Diploma in Marketing Management)
Equivalent to MBA in Marketing Management, Symbiosis Institute of Business Management, India
- PGDHM (Post Graduate Diploma in Hotel Management with Merit) Swiss Hotel Management School, Caux Montreux, Switzerland
- B.Com (Bachelors in Commerce)
All Saint's College, Trivandrum, India

Languages

- English - Fluent (reading, speaking, writing)
- Malayalam - Native
- Hindi - Fluent (reading, speaking, writing)
- Tamil - Conversational (speaking)
- Bahasa Indonesia - Basic (reading, speaking, writing)
- French - Basic (reading, speaking, writing)